BERNSTEIN
SOCIETE GENERALE GROUP

30 September 2026


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U.S. IT Hardware

Hewlett Packard Enterprise Co

Rating

Market-Perform

Price Target

HPE **62.00 USD**

HPE: What did we learn from HPE's Networking day?

HPE held its Networking day in Sunnyvale today. We summarize key points from the event.

HPE significantly increased Networking revenue growth target from 6% to high teens % (3-year CAGR), more in-line with the market. At last year's Securities Analyst Meeting (in October), the company outlined its growth target of 5-7% CAGR (FY25-28), which at the time was disappointing and slower than the market. This was just increased to high-teens% CAGR (FY26-29). Because HPE is over-indexed to the low-growth segments like Campus & Branch, and under-indexed to the highest growth segment of Datacenter networking, this implies that HPE is taking share. Indeed, they expect to grow faster than the market in Datacenter Networking (50s% CAGR) and Campus & Branch (high single digits % CAGR).

Networking operating margin target for FY27-29 remained unchanged at mid to high 20s%. However, cost synergies from Juniper have been increased from $600M to $800M.

In addition to long-term targets, **HPE also took up their FY27 Networking growth outlook** that it had just recently provided at their Q3 earnings from 14-17% to high teens to low 20s%, i.e. up about 4-5% at the midpoint, mainly due to the ***Helios/Vulture*** win. Management also expects FY27 to be more back-end loaded than usual due to the timing of Helios shipments and sees margin expansion from the low-20% range in FY26 to the mid-to-high 20% range in FY27 progressing linearly.

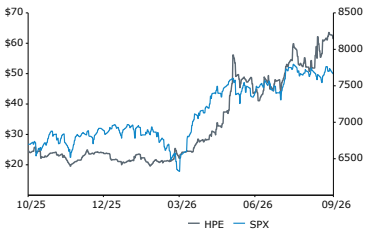
Melding AI and Networking: HPE emphasized its ***Self-Driving Network*** as a core philosophy prioritizing seamless user experiences over connectivity only. Management's original vision is now brought to life through the integration of Juniper Mist and Aruba Central.

Close Date	30 Sep 2026
HPE Close Price (USD)	63.89
Price Target (USD)	62.00
Upside/(Downside)	(3)%
52-Week Range	67.10/19.84
SPX	7,670.84
FYE	Oct
Div Yield	0.9%
Market Cap (USD) (M)	84,812
EV (USD) (M)	98,902

Performance	YTD	1M	6M	12M
Absolute (%)	166.0	22.3	168.3	160.1
SPX (%)	12.1	(0.5)	20.4	15.2
Relative (%)	153.9	22.8	147.9	145.0

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Price Performance, 1YR



Investment Implications

We rate HPE Market-Perform, TP unchanged at $62 (on 13.5x FY27 EPS). Although we welcome the increased growth targets, we don't see any reason to chase this given the move.

Adjusted EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E
HPE (USD)	1.96	3.84	4.59

Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR
Operating Margin (%)	9.8	14.7	15.1	--
EBIT (M)	3,353	6,847	8,196	--
Revenues (M)	34,296	46,604	54,219	--

Valuation Metrics	25A	26E	27E
EV/GP (x)	9.2	5.5	4.6
Adjusted P/E (x)	32.6	16.7	13.9
REL P/E Adjusted (x)	NA	NA	NA
Reported P/E (x)	32.6	16.7	13.9
REL P/E Reported (x)	NA	NA	NA
EV/FCF (x)	100.3	25.8	19.6
EV/EBITDA (x)	16.2	9.6	8.5

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

See the Disclosure Appendix of this report for required disclosures, analyst certifications and other important information. Alternatively, visit our Global Research Disclosure Website.

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DETAILS

HPE held its Networking day in Sunnyvale today. We summarize key points from the event in this note.

HPE significantly increased its Networking revenue growth target from 6% to high teens% (3-year CAGR), more in-line with the market.

At last year's Securities Analyst Meeting (in October), the company outlined its growth target of **5-7% CAGR (FY25-28)**, which at the time was disappointing and less than the market. HPE presented their updated Networking growth framework from FY26 through FY29, expecting overall revenue growth of **high-teens%** for the segment. Because HPE is over-indexed to the low-growth segments like Campus & Branch, and under-indexed to the highest growth segment of Datacenter networking, this implies that HPE is taking share.

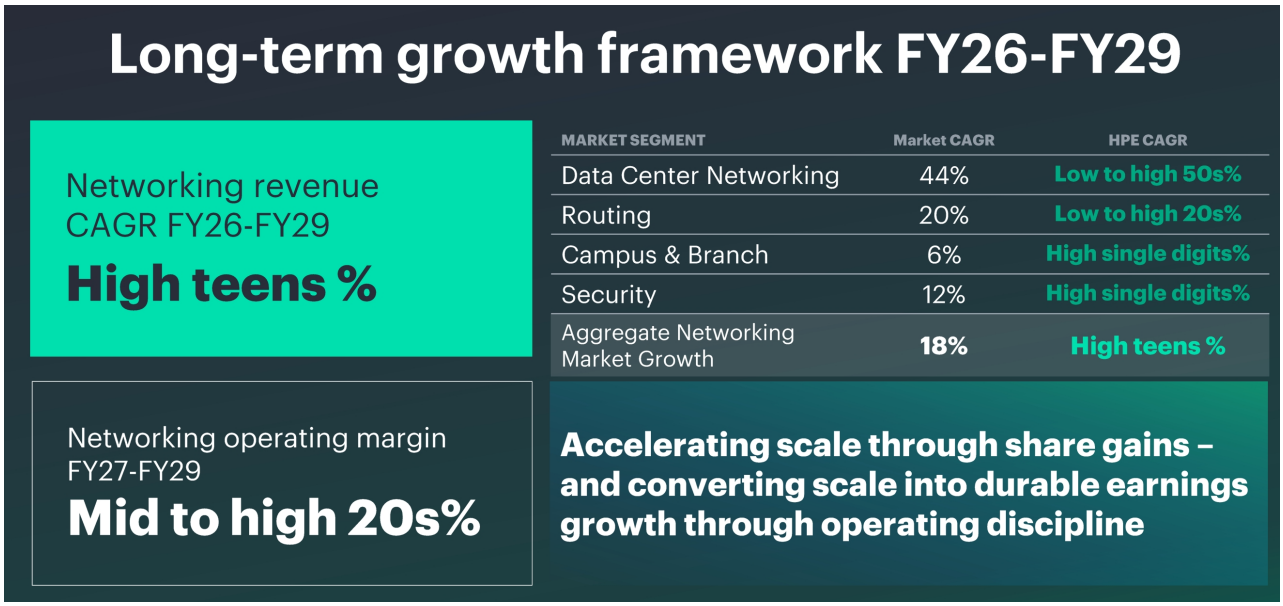
Within Networking, the company expects Datacenter to grow the fastest (low to high 50s%), followed by Routing (low to high 20%) and Campus & Branch and Security (HSD%, respectively). HPE plans to grow faster than the market in all segments except security. **Networking operating margin target for FY27-29 remained unchanged at mid to high 20s%** (Exhibit 1). However, cost synergies from Juniper have been increased from $600M to $800M (Exhibit 2).

In addition to long-term targets, **HPE also took up their FY27 Networking growth outlook** that it had just recently provided at their Q3 earnings from 14-17% to high teens to low 20s%, i.e. up about 4-5% at the midpoint, mainly due to the Helios/ Vulture win. Management also expects FY27 to be more back-end loaded than usual due to the timing of Helios shipments and sees margin expansion from the low-20% range in FY26 to the mid-to-high 20% range in FY27 progressing linearly. (Exhibit 3)

HPE emphasized its Self-Driving Network as a core philosophy prioritizing seamless user experience over just connectivity ("Up is not the same as good").

Management highlighted that their original vision is now brought to life through the integration of Juniper Mist and Aruba Central, delivering agentic AI-driven automation and protection from the client to the cloud with Marvis, their AI-engine working in the background to optimize the network and providing customer support as needed. According to the company some key tangible benefits include faster deployment times (from years to months) and a significant reduction of support tickets (>90% in some cases). Management noted that HPE's approach also differentiates itself by providing the ability to extend security measures directly to the access point or switch port, enabling the rapid detection and isolation of compromised devices and end points, particularly in complex IoT environments. (Exhibit 4)

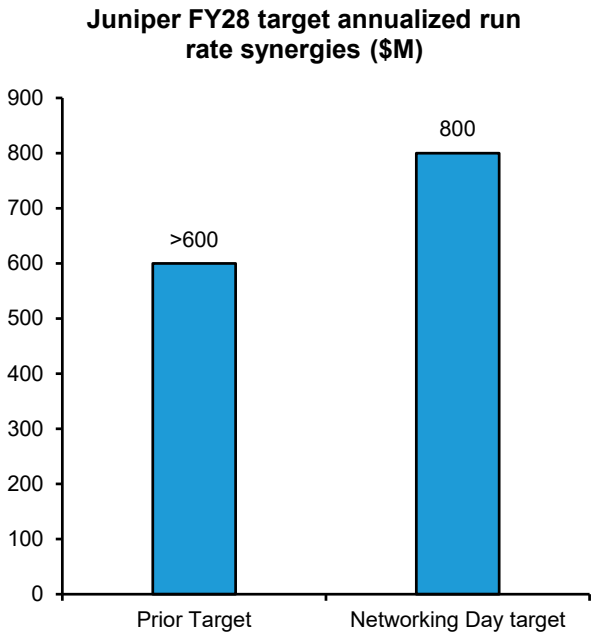
EXHIBIT 1: **Long-term growth framework FY26-29**



MARKET SEGMENT	Market CAGR	HPE CAGR
Data Center Networking	44%	Low to high 50s%
Routing	20%	Low to high 20s%
Campus & Branch	6%	High single digits%
Security	12%	High single digits%
Aggregate Networking Market Growth	**18%**	High teens %

Market growth rates are based on CY26-CY29. HPE outlook is based on FY26-FY29, with fiscal years ending October 31. Total Market CAGR is based on analyst forecasts, aligned with HPE Networking portfolio mix. HPE estimates includes support & maintenance revenue CAGR.
Source: HPE, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 2: **HPE took up their FY28 cost synergy targets by ~$200M**



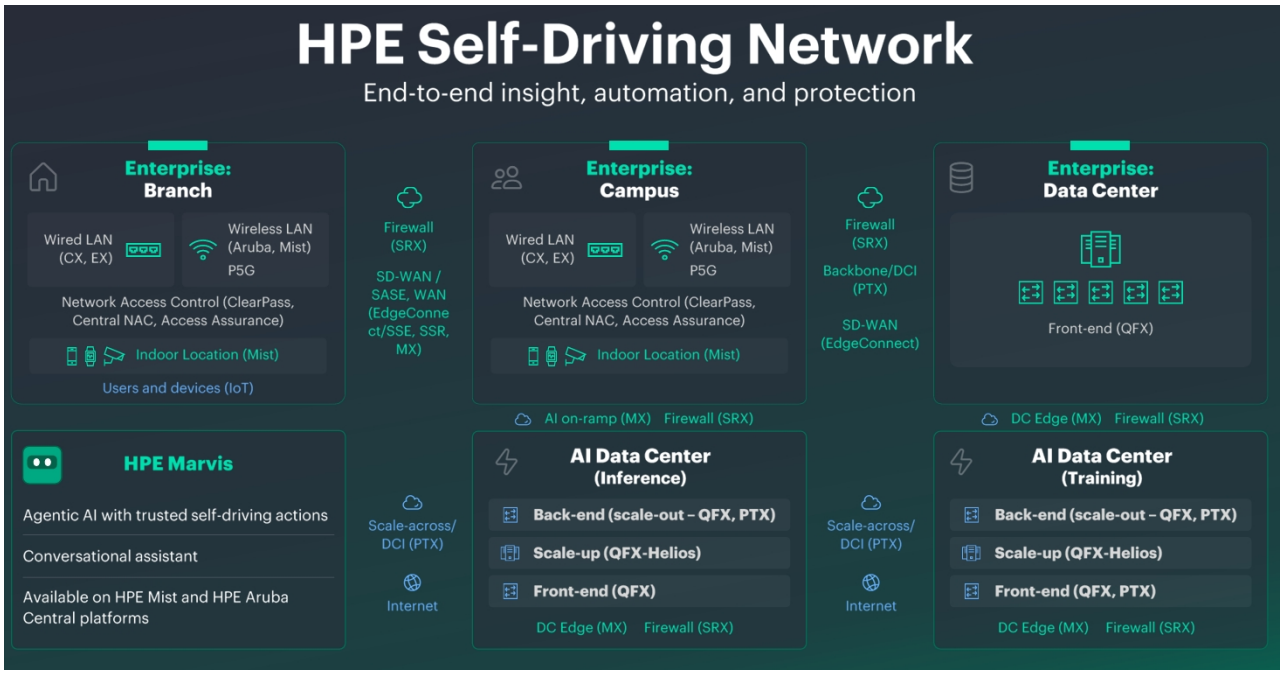
Source: Company reports, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 3: **HPE took up their FY27 Networking Revenue growth outlook from 14-17% at their last earnings to high teens to low 20s% but left their margin outlook unchanged**

	Networking Revenue Growth	Networking Operating Margin
FY26E	~10%	low 20s%
FY27 Guide (Q3 earnings call)	14% - 17%	Mid to high 20s%
FY27 Guide (Networking Day)	High teens to low 20s%	Mid to high 20s%
FY27 Guide Midpoint (Networking Day)	~20%	~26.5%
FY27 Consensus	15.7%	25.5%
Guide vs Consensus	~4%	~1%

Source: Bloomberg, Company reports, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 4: **HPE's Self Driving Network**



Source: HPE

APPENDIX - FINANCIAL FORECASTS

EXHIBIT 5: **HPE Income Statement and Balance Sheet**

Non-GAAP Income Statement	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	Q1 26	Q2 26	Q3 26	Q4 26E
Total Revenues	**$34,296**	**$46,604**	**$54,219**	**$59,530**	**$64,789**	**$9,301**	**$10,678**	**$12,213**	**$14,412**
COGS	$23,491	$28,521	$32,802	$36,314	$39,521	5,898	6,741	7,285	8,597
Gross Profit	**$10,805**	**18,083**	**21,416**	**23,217**	**25,268**	**3,403**	**3,937**	**4,928**	**5,815**
OPEX						2,221	2,514	2,949	3,552
R&D	$2,280	$3,920	$4,979	$5,666	$6,359	659	827	1,087	1,347
SG&A	$5,172	$7,316	$8,241	$9,049	$9,848	1,562	1,687	1,862	2,205
Operating Profit	**$3,353**	**$6,847**	**$8,196**	**$8,502**	**$9,061**	**1,182**	**1,423**	**1,979**	**2,263**
Interest and Other, Net	-$114	-$420	-$420	-$150	-$200	-101	-102	-107	-110
Income Before Tax	**$3,239**	**$6,427**	**$7,776**	**$8,352**	**$8,861**	**1,081**	**1,321**	**1,872**	**2,153**
Taxes	$486	$899	$1,166	$1,253	$1,329	151	185	262	301
Net Income	**$2,753**	**$5,528**	**$6,610**	**$7,100**	**$7,532**	**$930**	**$1,136**	**$1,610**	**$1,852**
Dilluted EPS without Adjustments	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0	0	0	0
Convertible Debt Interest Expense	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Reported EPS (ex SBC starting FY19)	**$1.96**	**$ 3.84**	**$ 4.59**	**$ 4.93**	**$ 5.37**	**$0.65**	**$0.79**	**$1.11**	**$1.29**
SBC per share	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00
Reported EPS including SBC	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**
Diluted Shares Outstanding	1,378	1,438	1,440	1,440	1,403	1,432	1,432	1,449	1,440
Memo: Tax Rate	15.0%	14.0%	15.0%	15.0%	15.0%	14.0%	14.0%	14.0%	14.0%
HPE - Balance Sheet ($M)									
ASSETS									
Cash and Cash Equivalents	5,773	8,837	11,095	14,071	17,398	4,841	5,292	6,216	8,837
Accounts Receivable	5,290	8,213	7,524	8,481	9,408	4,931	6,286	6,185	8,213
Inventory	6,352	10,363	10,014	11,242	12,993	6,913	9,034	11,823	10,363
Property, Plant and Equip.	6,002	5,677	6,116	6,383	6,546	5,911	5,597	5,645	5,677
Total Financing Receivables and Other	17,643	19,715	21,419	23,518	25,595	17,636	17,686	18,473	19,715
Goodwill / Intangible Assets	30,138	28,866	27,684	26,631	25,691	29,929	29,648	29,454	28,866
Other Assets	4,708	6,844	6,521	7,159	7,792	5,607	5,969	5,800	6,844
Total Assets	**75,906**	**88,516**	**90,372**	**97,485**	**105,424**	**75,768**	**79,512**	**83,596**	**88,516**
Accounts Payable	7,731	11,305	11,561	11,441	12,452	8,379	11,311	13,734	11,305
Other Current Liabilities (Deferred Revenue, Employee Comp)	12,303	21,312	19,994	22,255	24,512	12,072	12,655	16,702	21,312
Total Debt and Notes Payable	22,365	17,243	16,843	12,775	12,775	21,611	21,246	17,343	17,243
Other Non-Current Liabilities	8,753	11,131	10,442	11,623	12,802	8,872	8,947	9,241	11,131
Total Liabilities	**51,152**	**60,991**	**58,841**	**58,094**	**62,540**	**50,934**	**54,159**	**57,020**	**60,991**
HPE Shareholders' Equity	24,688	27,733	31,740	35,532	39,024	24,774	25,292	26,514	27,733
Non-Controlling Interest / Other	66	62	62	62	62	60	61	62	62
Total Shareholders' Equity	**24,754**	**27,795**	**31,802**	**35,594**	**39,086**	**24,834**	**25,353**	**26,576**	**27,795**
Total Liabilities and Shareholders' Equity	**75,906**	**88,786**	**90,643**	**93,688**	**101,626**	**75,768**	**79,512**	**83,596**	**88,786**

Source: Company reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 6: **HPE Cash Flow Statement**

Cash Flow	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	Q1 26	Q2 26	Q3 26	Q4 26E
Net income	57	4,043	4,904	7,100	7,532	452	624	1,540	1,427
Depreciation and amortization	2,737	3,472	3,401	3,444	3,434	872	877	864	859
Stock Based Compensation	643	812	793	883	972	216	218	165	213
Other	2,189	(9)	(46)	(46)	(46)	(593)	(5)	510	79
Difference b/t Non-Cash & Cash Restructuring	-	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Net change in deferred taxes / taxes on earnings	-	(313)	0	0	0	-151	288	-450	0
Change in Financing receivables	-	(1,466)	(1,704)	(2,098)	(2,077)	70	212	(506)	(1,242)
Change in Working Capital	-	(405)	300	(685)	(43)	312	(804)	(482)	569
Net cash provided by operating activities	**5,626**	**6,134**	**7,649**	**8,598**	**9,773**	**1,178**	**1,410**	**1,641**	**1,905**
Capex	(2,292)	(2,550)	(2,612)	(2,612)	(2,612)	(569)	(583)	(745)	(653)
Asset Dispositions	380	288	0	0	0	66	130	92	0
Net investment purchases / sales	973	1,362	0	0	0	-2	3	1361	0
Net Financial Collateral	(183)	52	0	0	0	-288	250	90	0
Acquisitions	(12,278)	-	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Divestitures	210	-	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Net cash used in investing activities	**(13,190)**	**(848)**	**(2,612)**	**(2,612)**	**(2,612)**	**(793)**	**(200)**	**798**	**(653)**
Debt-Related	2,343	(2,228)	(400)	-	-	(794)	(357)	(977)	(100)
Stock Buybacks	(491)	(998)	(793)	(3,191)	(3,943)	(331)	(164)	(290)	(213)
Dividends	(796)	(862)	(898)	(999)	(1,069)	(219)	(226)	(210)	(207)
Net transfer from former parent	-	-	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Other	(10)	1,882	(688)	1,181	1,179	(8)	8	(8)	1,890
Net cash used in financing activities	**1,046**	**(2,207)**	**(2,779)**	**(3,010)**	**(3,834)**	**-1352**	**-739**	**-1485**	**1369**
FX impact	(21)	-39	0	0	0	33	-42	-30	0
Net change in cash, cash equivalents and restricted cash	**(6,584)**	**3,040**	**2,258**	**2,976**	**3,327**	**(934)**	**429**	**924**	**2,621**
Net change in cash minus sum of cash flows	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Cash held for Sale	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Restricted cash	(3,963)	(3,987)	(3,987)	(3,987)	(3,987)	(3,965)	(3,987)	(3,987)	(3,987)
Cash, cash equivalents and restricted cash at start of period	8,190	1,810	4,850	7,108	10,084	1,810	876	1,305	2,229
Cash, cash equivalents and restricted cash at end of period	1,810	4,850	7,108	10,084	13,411	876	1,305	2,229	4,850
Free Cash Flow									
As reported:									
Free cash flow	986	3,833	5,037	5,986	7,161	708	915	958	1,252
Sum - Total	-	(0)	(0)	-	-	-	-	-	-
FCF growth	-57%	289%	31%	19%	20%	-63%	29%	5%	31%
FCF margin	3%	8%	9%	10%	11%	8%	9%	8%	9%
FCF per share	0.72	2.66	3.50	4.16	5.10	0.49	0.64	0.66	0.86

Source: Company reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

			30 Sep 2026		TTM	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
Ticker	Rating	Cur	Closing Price	Price Target	Rel. Perf.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
HPE (HPE)	M	USD	63.89	62.00	145.0%	USD	1.96	3.84	4.59	32.6	16.7	13.9
SPX			7,670.84									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

I. REQUIRED DISCLOSURES

References to "Bernstein" or the “Firm” in these disclosures relate to the following entities: Bernstein Institutional Services LLC (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein & Co., LLC (pre April 1, 2024), Bernstein Autonomous LLP, BSG France S.A. (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein (Hong Kong) Limited 盛博香港有限公司, Sanford C. Bernstein (Canada) Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein (India) Private Limited (SEBI registration no. INH000006378), Sanford C. Bernstein (Singapore) Private Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein Japan KK（サンフォード・C・バーンスタイン株式会社）and analysts employed by Société Générale Africa Technologies & Services to produce Bernstein research under a Global Services Agreement in place between Bernstein and Société Générale.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY

Hewlett Packard Enterprise Co

We value HPE at $62, which is roughly13.5x our FY27 EPS.

RISKS

Hewlett Packard Enterprise Co

The biggest risks to the upside on HPE and to our price target are that: 1) HPE has seen new additions to the senior management team, who could improve the company’s operational execution; 2) Revenue and/or cost synergies from the Juniper acquisition could be unexpectedly strong, driving a company transformation. The biggest risks to the downside are that 3) HPE could see continued mis-steps in the server business or in its merger integration with Juniper, not only pressuring results but also opening opportunities for competitors to poach key accounts.

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION

EQUITY RATINGS DEFINITIONS

Bernstein brand

The Bernstein brand rates stocks based on forecasts of relative performance for the next 12 months versus the S&P 500 for stocks listed on the U.S. and Canadian exchanges, versus the Bloomberg Europe Developed Markets Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index EUR (EDME) for stocks listed on the European exchanges and emerging markets exchanges outside of the Asia Pacific region, versus the Bloomberg Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index USD (JPL) for stocks listed on the Japanese exchanges, and versus the Bloomberg Asia ex-Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index (ASIAX) for stocks listed on the Asian (ex-Japan) exchanges -unless otherwise specified.

The Bernstein brand has three categories of ratings:

- Outperform: Stock will outpace the market index by more than 15 pp
- Market-Perform: Stock will perform in line with the market index to within +/-15 pp
- Underperform: Stock will trail the performance of the market index by more than 15 pp

Coverage Suspended: Coverage of a company under the Bernstein research brand has been suspended. Ratings and price targets are suspended temporarily, are no longer current, and should therefore not be relied upon.

Not Rated: A rating assigned when the stock cannot be accurately valued, or the performance of the company accurately predicted, at the present time. The covering analyst may continue to publish research reports on the company to update investors on events and developments.

Not Covered (NC) denotes companies that are not under coverage.

Bernstein brand stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

Autonomous brand – common stocks

The Autonomous brand rates common stocks as indicated below. As our benchmarks we use the Bloomberg Europe 600 Financials Price Return Index (E600BK) and Bloomberg Europe Dev Mkt Financials Large and Mid Cap Price Ret Index EUR (EDMFI) index for developed European banks and Payments, the Bloomberg Europe 600 Insurance Price Return Index (E600IN) for European insurers, the S&P 500 and S&P Financials for US banks and Payments coverage, S5LIFE for US Insurance, the S&P Insurance Select Industry (SPSIINS) for US Non-Life Insurers coverage, the Bloomberg Emerging Markets Financials Large, Mid and Small Cap Price Return Index (EMLSF) for emerging market banks and insurers and Payments, and the Bloomberg Japan Financials Large & Mid Cap Price Return Index (JPFILM) for Japanese Financials. Ratings are stated relative to the sector (not the market).

The Autonomous brand has three categories of common stock ratings:

- Outperform (OP): Stock will outpace the relevant index by more than 10 pp
- Neutral (N): Stock will perform in line with the market index to within +/-10 pp
- Underperform (UP): Stock will trail the performance of the relevant index by more than 10 pp

Coverage Suspended: Coverage of a company under the Autonomous research brand has been suspended. Ratings and price targets are suspended temporarily, are no longer current, and should therefore not be relied upon.

Not Rated: A rating assigned when the stock cannot be accurately valued, or the performance of the company accurately predicted, at the present time. The covering analyst may continue to publish research reports on the company to update investors on events and developments.

Those denoted as 'Feature' (e.g., Feature Outperform FOP, Feature Under Outperform FUP) are our core ideas.

Not Covered (NC) denotes companies that are not under coverage.

Autonomous brand common stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

Autonomous brand – preferred stocks

The Autonomous brand has three categories of preferred stock ratings:

- Outperform (OP): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to outperform preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- Neutral (N): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to perform in line with preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- Underperform (UP): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to underperform preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.

Autonomous preferred stock ratings are based on a 6-month time horizon.

AUTONOMOUS CREDIT RESEARCH

Where this report contains investment recommendations for credit instruments, as defined in article 3(1)(35) of the Market Abuse Regulation, the information below is presented to comply with its disclosure requirements.

The report may also include reference(s) to published opinions by other Autonomous or Bernstein analysts covering the equity securities of the issuer(s) referenced herein. Please note an investment recommendation for credit instruments published by the author(s) of this report may differ from the published view of the analyst covering equity securities for the issuer(s) contained in this report and vice versa.

CREDIT RATINGS DEFINITIONS

The Autonomous brand has three categories of credit ratings:

- Credit Outperform (C-OP): The total return of the Reference Credit Instrument is expected to outperform the credit spread of bonds of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- Credit Neutral (C-N): The total return of the Reference Credit Instrument is expected to perform in line with the credit spread of bonds of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- Credit Underperform (C-UP): The total return of the Reference Credit Instrument is expected to underperform the credit spread of bonds of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.

Autonomous credit ratings are based on a 6-month time horizon.

A list of all investment recommendations produced by the author(s) of this report alongside credit ratings history are available upon request.

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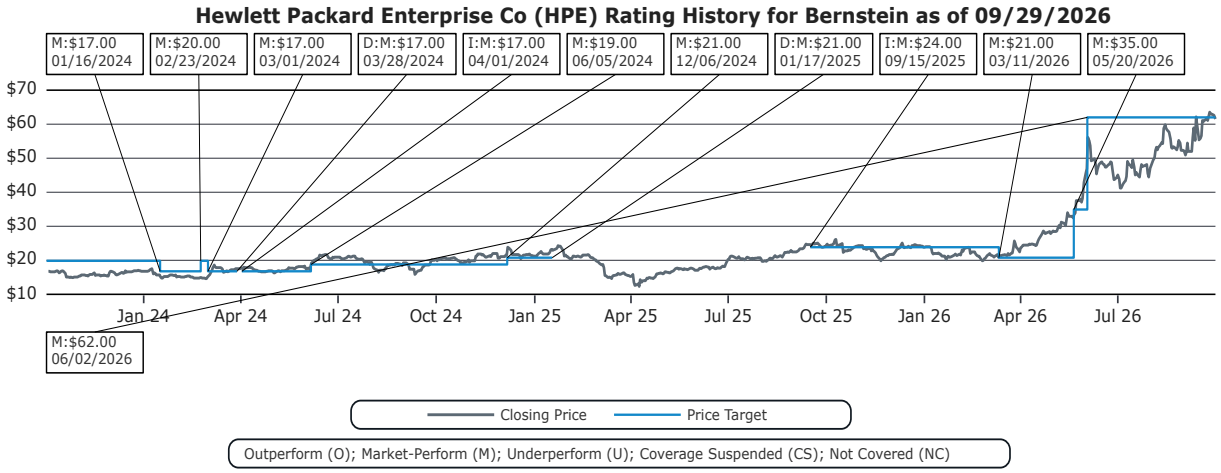
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Outperform	BUY	51.2%	15.3%
Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand) Neutral (Autonomous Brand)	HOLD	35.8%	16.2%
Underperform	SELL	13.1%	13.6%

* These figures represent the percentage of companies within each equity rating category for which affiliates of Bernstein have provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.
As of June 30, 2026. All figures are updated quarterly.

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